



EA promotes Laura Miele to COO

EA is promoting chief studios officer Laura Miele to chief operating officer.
<https://dgit.in/oct21-84>



Zoom won't buy Five9

Though a press release from Five9 says it was "terminated by mutual agreement".
<https://dgit.in/oct21-93>

Samsung Galaxy S22 Ultra

Boo-man hates on the future...

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

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any of you are wondering why on earth I'm boo-ing a phone that hasn't even launched yet, or for

that matter, one which we hardly know anything about. Another set of you who follow digit.in updates will know that Digit was, in fact, the one to leak the first 3D renders of the Samsung Galaxy S22 Ultra in collaboration with OnLeaks. You can read that leak story here: <https://dgit.in/s22ultra>

Samsung's upcoming top of the range phone is expected to be released in early 2022, and while it's likely to look like the renders Digit put out, I for one am hoping it does not look like that!

For starters the camera housing on the back is shaped like a P! Other renders suggest that the camera housing might be divided into two vertical rows instead of a P-shaped single glass cover... but I'm not holding my breath. For one thing, the two rows of cameras mean two sets of protective glass on top of the cameras. This would make the phone *easier* to repair, because you might crack only one of the lens covers. It would also make it a lot easier for third party vendors (mostly Chinese), to be able to produce el-cheapo replacements... I honestly cannot believe that any large manufacturer would improve on a flagship device's repairability index! Whilst Samsung aren't as bad as some others in this aspect (**cough*Apple*cough**) they're not exactly interested in making devices that last forever and are easy to repair!

I get that it's hard to fit an odd number of cameras and sensors into the camera housing, and the P-shaped



design might be borne out of necessity and not be a design call, but it still sucks! They might as well have gone for broke and tried to shape it like a G (for "Galaxy"), or an S (for "Samsung").

What's really irking me, however, is the death of the Note lineup. Sadly, with Samsung pushing their foldable devices, they seem to have killed off the Note lineup altogether, and just added a stylus to the most expensive Galaxy.

Apart from the rather combusive nature of the Note 7 turning people off, almost every Samsung Note device had a cult following, and with good reason too! While not everyone preferred the larger form factor and screen size, it was always something people like me looked forward to.

While I don't have any evidence to support my theory, I do believe that people who use a stylus with their phones are a tad

more sophisticated, spend less time on frivolous nonsense, and just get more done on a daily basis. Or maybe I'm just a narcissist who considers myself superior to all other humans. And cleaner too!

At least the Note launches would always follow after the Galaxy launches, and this meant that whatever learnings they had from the Galaxy series of that year, Samsung could fix in the Note lineup – whether it was small hardware flaws, or UI and software niggles, I always found the Note lineup to be more polished.

I remember when the original Note pushed the screen size to over 5 inches, which was a big deal at the time! Seems funny now that we once called displays that were under 6-inch, "phablets"!

The Note 7 fiasco almost killed the Note lineup before the Note 10 Plus redeemed the series, even despite dropping the much-loved headphone jack! The Note 20 Ultra, arguably the best Note ever, changed things around. Instead of being a more polished upgrade to that year's Galaxy device, it turned out to be a precursor for the top of the line Galaxy S21 model.

And now the Note lineup is dead. It's been made irrelevant by Samsung's wager on foldable devices as the future, and swallowed up by the Galaxy series. This really pi**es me off! Samsung believes that business users like me will just buy their Fold series in order to meet my stylus demands. And if I don't like foldable devices, then I will have to shell out for the top of the line Galaxy device, which may not be

built around stylus usage like the Note series was... Of course it's not out yet, and maybe it will be a Note device with just Galaxy branding, but that's about the best I can hope for, which is why... Boo you Samsung!



Looks like I'm not the only one who despises the render designs